

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 21, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 44:1-14

1 Then He brought me back to the outer gate of the sanctuary which faces toward the east, but it was shut.

2 And the Lord said to me, "This gate shall be shut; it shall not be opened, and no man shall enter by it, because the Lord God of Israel has entered by it; therefore it shall be shut.

3 As for the prince, because he is the prince, he may sit in it to eat bread before the Lord; he shall enter by way of the vestibule of the gateway, and go out the same way."

4 Also He brought me by way of the north gate to the front of the temple; so I looked, and behold, the glory of the Lord filled the house of the Lord; and I fell on my face.

5 And the Lord said to me, "Son of man, mark well, see with your eyes and hear with your ears, all that I say to you concerning all the ordinances of the house of the Lord and all its laws. Mark well who may enter the house and all who go out from the sanctuary.

6 Now say to the rebellious, to the house of Israel, 'Thus says the Lord God: "O house of Israel, let Us have no more of all your abominations.

7 When you brought in foreigners, uncircumcised in heart and uncircumcised in flesh, to be in My sanctuary to defile it—My house—and when you offered My food, the fat and the blood, then they broke My covenant because of all your abominations.

8 And you have not kept charge of My holy things, but you have set others to keep charge of My sanctuary for you."

9 Thus says the Lord God: "No foreigner, uncircumcised in heart or uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter My sanctuary, including any foreigner who is among the children of Israel.

10 And the Levites who went far from Me, when Israel went astray, who strayed away from Me after their idols, they shall bear their iniquity.

11 Yet they shall be ministers in My sanctuary, as gatekeepers of the house and ministers of the house; they shall slay the burnt offering and the sacrifice for the people, and they shall

stand before them to minister to them.

12 Because they ministered to them before their idols and caused the house of Israel to fall into iniquity, therefore I have raised My hand in an oath against them," says the Lord God, "that they shall bear their iniquity.

13 And they shall not come near Me to minister to Me as priest, nor come near any of My holy things, nor into the Most Holy Place; but they shall bear their shame and their abominations which they have committed.

14 Nevertheless I will make them keep charge of the temple, for all its work, and for all that has to be done in it.

II. Key Summary

- God brings Ezekiel back to the outer gate of the sanctuary facing east, and it is shut; God says the gate must stay shut and no man may enter by it, because the Lord has entered by it (vv. 1-2).
 - God rebukes the house of Israel for bringing foreigners uncircumcised in heart and flesh into His sanctuary, defiling His house and breaking His covenant, and declares that such people shall not enter His sanctuary (vv. 6-9).
 - The Levites who strayed away from God after their idols shall bear their iniquity and may no longer serve as priests or come near the most holy things, yet God still makes them keep charge of the temple and all its work (vv. 10-14).
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III. Passage Analysis

A shut gate is God saying, "I am not leaving"

The closure of the gate then is... an encouraging one... Since God will never leave the temple again, the gate will remain closed. [1]

A shut gate sounds like being locked out, but it is really about where God is: He came in, and He stayed. Ezekiel had once watched God's glory leave the temple; now this gate fixes in place the promise that He will not leave again.

God lets those who strayed carry the cost, and still keeps them

Although they also sinned (vv. 10-13), God forgave their sin and continued to entrust them with service (1 Timothy 1:12). [2]

The Levites had served idols, and that carried real consequences—no more priesthood, no coming near the most holy things. Yet God did not send them away; He still handed them the work of guarding the temple and keeping its gates.

IV. Reflection Question

Do you think what you have done decides whether God still wants to use you?

The Levites strayed, and God let them bear their own iniquity—yet He still kept them serving in His sanctuary.

References

[1] Enduring Word (David Guzik), David Guzik, Commentary on Ezekiel 44, quoting Vawter and Hoppe, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-44/>

[2] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website (ccbiblestudy.org), Grace Bible Study Commentary (聖經精讀本), Ezekiel Chapter 44, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT44.htm>